

MIRROR PAGE

Implementation plan for Hours 12 to 100. In a comic, the light is your weapon and the narrator is cheating.

Developer	Sankeerth Nara (solo)	Repository	github.com/SankeerthNara/TGC-Game-Jam (public, MIT)
Themes	Comic, Twist, Light (all three)	Engine	Godot 4.7, GDScript, Compatibility renderer, Web export
Final playtime	12 to 15 minutes (20 max)	Plan status	Concept locked at Hour 12. Features below are committed or marked stretch.

1. WHERE WE ARE AT HOUR 12 (ALREADY BUILT AND VERIFIED)

- **Core loop:** a dark comic-studio level where only the area around the hero's torch is lit. The hero walks smoothly in 8 directions. Each level has 5 to 8 interactive tasks that fill a progress bar.
- **4 generated levels** of 8 rooms in a random (non-grid) layout, with rising difficulty, a map screen, checkpoints at each level start, respawn on death, and level and total timers with a split summary.
- **13 task types:** wires, fuse box, lantern code, torch charge, telescope, ink spills, card swipe (classic style) plus comic tasks (order panels, fill speech bubbles, letter sound effects), college tasks (debug code, logic gates, shelf books) and the original light puzzle pages (drag panels, flip mirrors, steer a beam) with the goal-flip, lying-mirror and gutter-bend rule twists.
- **Sabotage and health:** risky tasks start a countdown; a fix console must be completed in time or the hero loses a heart. Zero hearts means respawn at the checkpoint.
- **Tooling:** level and puzzle validators, headless unit tests, a browser (WebGL) build verified, comic UI, menus, CC0 audio, open fonts.

2. COMMITTED FEATURES FOR THE REMAINING 88 HOURS

#	Feature	What it adds	Hours
1	The Saboteur (visible imposter)	An ink creature roams each level. It runs from torchlight, freezes in the beam, and sets off sabotage when it reaches a console. Catching it in the light stops the timer. Makes the darkness the core tension (Light + Twist).	20
2	Two fights (small + final boss)	Small fight (end of levels 2 and 3): cornering the Saboteur splits it into three ink blobs in a short arena. Hold the torch beam on each blob to burn it away while they rush you in the dark. Final boss fight (end of level 4): the villain duel in three phases. The torch is the weapon and rotating arena mirrors bounce the beam onto the villain's shield; the villain snuffs your torch, floods the floor with ink and attacks the interface (swapped controls). Hearts decide it; losing means respawn at the level checkpoint.	20 (7 + 13)
3	A comic genre per level	Level 1 superhero pulp, 2 noir black and white, 3 manga, 4 pop-art: palette, fonts, caption style, onomatopoeia and music change per level (Comic).	9
4	Fourth-wall twists	The narrator attacks the interface: lying captions, a fake progress bar, a wrong map, swapped controls for part of a level, HUD glitches. Final reveal: the narrator cut the lights because the comic is being cancelled; after the boss fight the player rewrites the last page (Twist).	11
5	Comic look and juice	Ink outline and halftone screen shader, panel-split and page-turn level transitions, onomatopoeia on actions and hits, narrator speech bubbles with text blips.	8
6	Ranks and replay	S/A/B medals per level from time and hearts lost, best splits saved locally.	4
7	First-minute polish	A 30 second in-level tutorial, controls hints, itch.io page with GIFs, README, CREDITS, AI usage log.	6
8	Balance and testing	Difficulty tuning of tasks, sabotage timers and both fights, outside playtests, bug fixing, web performance checks.	10

STRETCH (only after all of the above are playable, in this order): light puzzle rooms in the world (rotate real mirrors to open a door), a torch battery with recharge lamps, reactive music (faster while a timer runs). **Cut first** if time is short: stretch items, then medals, then the manga and pop-art levels (fallback: palette swaps only), then the boss mirror phase (fallback: a two-phase boss with torch damage only).

Fixed limits: 4 levels (no more), no multiplayer, no save slots, no level editor, no new engine features. Quality over quantity.

3. ROADMAP AND MILESTONES

Hours	Work	Exit criteria (a playable build every 12 hours)
12 - 30	Plan locked. Controls and camera polish, tutorial in level 1, level 1 genre art pass (pulp), reactive caption and narrator bubbles, first version of the comic shader, web build and audio check.	Level 1 is fun and good-looking, plays start to finish in the browser.
30 - 55	The Saboteur: patrol AI, light reaction (flee and freeze), sabotage triggers, catch rules, tuning. The small ink-blob fight at the end of levels 2 and 3. Fourth-wall twist scripting for levels 1 to 3. Genre art for levels 2 and 3 (noir, manga).	Levels 1 to 3 playable with the Saboteur, the small fight and at least two interface twists.
55 - 75	Level 4 (pop-art), the final boss fight (three phases, torch and mirrors), the reveal and last-page puzzle, transitions between levels, onomatopoeia and screen juice, medals and ranks, audio mix.	Full 12 to 15 minute run from menu through the boss to the ending.
75 - 85	Balance pass, outside playtests, bug fixing, performance, accessibility (colour contrast, key hints). Feature freeze at Hour 85.	No known blocking bugs; difficulty curve confirmed by testers.
85 - 96	Only fixes. Final web export, itch.io page and trailer GIFs, README, CREDITS and AI usage audit, commit history check.	Public itch.io build submitted by Hour 96.
96 - 100	Safety margin. Re-verify the live itch.io build and the repository.	Strict code freeze at Hour 100.

4. HOW THE WORK IS SPLIT

- **Claude Code:** architecture, Saboteur AI, level generator, twist scripting, bug fixing, code review and merges.
- **Antigravity:** art direction per genre, UI, shaders and transitions, audio, browser (Playwright) playtests, the itch.io page.
- **ChatGPT / Codex:** tests, balance data, documentation, README and CREDITS, small isolated features.
- **Developer (Sankeerth):** all design decisions, narrator script and story direction, the playtests, every merge to `main`. Design choices are logged in `docs/DESIGN_LOG.md`.
- **Method:** each tool works in its own git worktree and owns separate folders, a shared task board (`docs/TASKS.md`) tracks everything, commits are small and frequent so the history is auditable.

5. QUALITY, COMPLIANCE AND RISKS

Area	Plan
Stability	Headless unit tests for the puzzle model, level validator for every puzzle, a generator test that builds 100+ levels and checks reachability, a Playwright browser run on every milestone build.
Assets	Only free, CC0, CC BY, open-source or AI-generated assets. Everything listed in <code>CREDITS.md</code> and on the itch.io page. No paid assets.
AI disclosure	Claude Code, Antigravity and ChatGPT/Codex are used for code, art, audio and documents. Every use is logged in <code>docs/AI_USAGE.md</code> . Core design and story direction are the developer's.
Code origin	All game code is written inside the 100 hours. Only a generic empty Godot project and an editor plugin used for tooling (not part of the game) were present at the start; the plugin is credited.
Risk: Saboteur AI is too hard to tune	Keep the AI simple (patrol, flee from light, freeze in the beam). Fallback: it only triggers sabotage on a fixed schedule and the player can still stop it with the fix console.
Risk: combat is not fun	Both fights reuse existing mechanics (torch light, mirrors, hearts) instead of a new combat system. Attacks are slow and readable. Early playtests at Hour 45 (small fight) and Hour 70 (boss). Fallbacks: the small fight becomes a freeze-and-catch moment, the boss drops to two phases without mirrors.
Risk: art style workload	Genres are palette, font and caption swaps over one shared set of procedural shapes. Fallback: two genres instead of four.
Risk: web performance	2D lights are limited to the hero's torch; test every milestone in a browser; keep the export under 40 MB.
Risk: AI quota limits	Work is split across three tools with a handoff note on the task board; the developer reassigns tasks to whichever tool has quota left.

6. DEFINITION OF DONE

- A public itch.io page with a playable browser build of the full 12 to 15 minute game.
- The README shows the itch.io link, setup, controls and team details. CREDITS and the AI usage log are complete.
- The final game matches this plan: all committed features present, nothing from the cut list promised.